PROJECT REPORT

Digital Literacy

***Branch**: CSE(core)*
***Registration No.**: 25BCE11195*
***Year**: 1st Year(2025-2029)*
***Course Code**: CSE0001*
***Date**: 29th March 2026*

HARSH GURJAR

harsh.25bce11195@vitbhopal.ac.in

1. Abstract

This report presents a comprehensive overview of my Digital Literacy Project completed as part of the CSE0001 course at VIT Bhopal University. As a Student Digital Ambassador, the objective of this project was to develop a strong, responsible, and professional digital presence while gaining practical exposure to essential digital tools and cybersecurity practices. The project is divided into five major modules, each focusing on a different dimension of digital literacy, including visual communication, professional identity development, technical collaboration, communication ethics, and cybercrime awareness.

Through these modules, I explored tools such as Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, HackerRank, and Google Workspace to build both technical and non-technical competencies. A significant part of this project was also dedicated to understanding digital threats, particularly UPI fraud, and developing awareness strategies to prevent such risks.

This project highlights the transition from basic digital usage to advanced digital citizenship, where an individual not only consumes information but also contributes meaningfully, ethically, and securely to the digital ecosystem. The report reflects my learning journey, challenges faced, and the long-term impact of digital literacy on my academic and professional career as a Computer Science student.

---

2. Introduction to Digital Literacy

Digital literacy has evolved beyond basic computer knowledge into a critical life skill required in the modern technological era. It involves the ability to effectively use digital tools, evaluate information critically, communicate responsibly, and ensure personal and professional security online. For a Computer Science student, digital literacy is not optional—it is foundational.

In today's digital-first world, students are constantly interacting with online platforms for education, communication, coding, and career development. Therefore, understanding how to navigate these platforms responsibly is essential. Digital literacy can be broadly divided into four key components:

- **Information Literacy:** The ability to identify reliable sources and critically evaluate online content.
- **Technical Proficiency:** Knowledge of tools such as GitHub, coding platforms, and collaborative software.
- **Cybersecurity Awareness:** Understanding risks like phishing, fraud, and data breaches.

- **Professional Branding:** Creating a strong and credible online identity.

As a student at VIT Bhopal, developing these skills ensures that I am not only technically capable but also professionally prepared for the industry. This project plays a crucial role in shaping my digital behavior and preparing me for real-world challenges.

---

3. Module 1: Visual Communication & Information Design

3.1 Methodology

In this module, I used Canva, a powerful cloud-based graphic design platform, to create an infographic on Digital Literacy Awareness. The central theme of the infographic was "The Three Pillars of Digital Safety": Verification, Privacy, and Professionalism. The goal was to communicate important digital safety practices in a visually engaging and easily understandable format.

3.2 Content Analysis

The infographic included key elements such as:

- **Safe Browsing Practices:** Identifying secure websites using HTTPS and avoiding suspicious links.
- **Data Privacy Awareness:** Avoiding oversharing personal information on social media.
- **Digital Etiquette (Netiquette):** Maintaining professionalism in online interactions.

Each section was designed using icons, minimal text, and structured layouts to improve readability and engagement.

3.3 Reflection

The main challenge in this module was organizing complex information into a simple and visually appealing design. I learned that effective communication is not just about content but also about presentation. As a Digital Ambassador, it is important to ensure that information reaches the audience in a clear and impactful manner.

---

4. Module 2: Building a Professional Digital Identity

4.1 Platforms and Setup

In this module, I created and optimized profiles on key professional platforms:

- **GitHub:** I developed a profile showcasing my coding projects and focused on improving my skills in Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA). My repositories serve as a live portfolio of my technical work.
- **LinkedIn:** I built a professional profile highlighting my academic background, skills, and role as a Student Digital Ambassador.
- **Kaggle:** I created an account to explore data science competitions and enhance my analytical skills.

4.2 Strategic Importance

A professional digital identity acts as a "digital resume." Recruiters often evaluate candidates based on their online presence. A well-maintained GitHub profile demonstrates consistency, problem-solving ability, and technical expertise. Similarly, LinkedIn helps in networking and building professional connections.

This module taught me the importance of maintaining an active and professional online presence, which can significantly impact career opportunities.

---

5. Module 3: Technical Collaboration & Problem Solving

5.1 Coding Practice

I used HackerRank to solve beginner-level Python problems. This helped me strengthen my logical thinking, improve coding skills, and understand algorithmic concepts. Regular practice also improved my confidence in solving technical problems.

5.2 Cloud Collaboration (Google Workspace)

I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The quiz included questions on topics such as:

- Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)
- UPI safety
- Phishing attacks

The responses were automatically recorded in Google Sheets, enabling easy analysis and data visualization.

5.3 Academic Application

These tools are extremely useful in academic projects. GitHub helps in version control, while Google Forms and Sheets simplify data collection and analysis. This module enhanced my productivity and collaboration skills.

---

6. Module 4: Professional Communication & Social Ethics

6.1 Email Etiquette

Professional communication is a key skill in the corporate world. I drafted two types of emails:

1. **Extension Request Email:** Focused on clarity, politeness, and justification.
2. **Internship Inquiry Email:** Highlighted my skills and included links to my GitHub profile.

This exercise helped me understand the importance of tone, structure, and clarity in professional emails.

6.2 Social Media Governance

I created a checklist of do's and don'ts for social media usage. I also studied real-life cases where individuals faced consequences due to inappropriate online behavior.

Key takeaways include:

- Avoid posting offensive or controversial content.
- Maintain a clear distinction between personal and professional life.
- Regularly review and clean up digital footprints.

---

7. Module 5: Cybercrime Awareness (Case Study)

7.1 UPI / Online Payment Fraud Analysis

In this module, I conducted a case study on UPI fraud, which is increasingly common among students. The most common fraud method involves "Collect Requests," where attackers trick users into entering their UPI PIN.

A major misconception is that a PIN is required to receive money. In reality, a PIN is only required to authorize payments (sending money).

7.2 Prevention Framework

I developed an 8-point safety guide, including:

- Never share UPI PIN or OTP.
- Verify payment requests before approving.
- Use trusted apps only.
- Report fraud immediately using the **1930 helpline**.
- File complaints on the National Cyber Crime Portal.

This module increased my awareness of digital threats and taught me how to educate others about online safety.

---

8. Discussion: The Impact of Digital Ambassadorship

Being a Student Digital Ambassador has significantly influenced my approach to technology. It has made me more conscious of my digital behavior and encouraged me to adopt best practices in security, communication, and professional development.

It has also motivated me to focus on Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA), as sharing accurate and valuable technical content is essential in this role. The experience has enhanced my leadership skills and strengthened my ability to guide peers in digital literacy.

---

9. Conclusion

This project demonstrates that digital literacy is a dynamic and essential skill set for modern students, especially those in the field of Computer Science. From creating infographics to building professional profiles and understanding cyber threats, each module contributed to my overall development.

The knowledge and skills gained through this project will not only help me in my academic journey but also prepare me for future career opportunities. This report marks the beginning of my professional digital journey, where I aim to continuously learn, adapt, and contribute responsibly to the digital world.

---

10. Appendices & References

- **Appendix A:** GitHub Repository Link
- **Appendix B:** Google Form Link

References:

- VITyarthi Portal
- National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)
- HackerRank Python Documentation